CMU PhD Student Actually Born Yesterday

Mar. K. O.
Competition Scout

As college admissions become more and more competitive, so do the applications for graduate school. So competitive, in fact, that a newborn child was recently spotted being wheeled in a carriage over to their Advanced Statistical Theory II seminar.

Savants are nothing new at CMU, but one-day-old Weiss Babeigh certainly sets a new bar, pursuing a Ph.D. under all seven departments of SCS. Her seminal work in hyperefficient Bayesian inference, which she published nine hours ago, is expected to revolutionize the modern fields of statistics and AI. Professors say Babeigh is a pleasure to have in class, with one MLD faculty member noting that she "poops her pants slightly less often than the other computer science grad students."

The young prodigy is expected to finish her various doctorates within six months, most of which will be spent waiting for researchers to finish writing their praises of her work. Post-graduation, Babeigh plans to enroll in preschool, citing a strong interest in juice boxes, Bluey, and the color yellow.

When asked about a potential return to research, Babeigh responded: "baaaaaah shplebablabbbbbbbbbaaaaah baaaaeeeeuhhhh," before promptly shitting herself. Tiger parents worldwide have begun rigorously training their infants, anticipating a nightmare scenario where their child might not be the most intelligent one in the room.

Don't ask Scotty who she *cheered for during the 2026 Winter Olympics //* **Gilgamesh**

YOUR HOROSCOPE

ARIES	♈	You will be killed by a Virgo.
TAURUS	♉	You will be killed by a Virgo.
GEMINI	♊	You will be killed by a Virgo.
CANCER	♋	You will be killed by a Virgo.
LEO	♌	You will be killed by a Virgo.
VIRGO	♍	Discard that which no longer serves you.
LIBRA	♎	You will be killed by a Virgo.
SCORPIO	♏	You will be killed by a Virgo.
SAGITTARIUS	♐	You will be killed by a Virgo.
CAPRICORN	♑	You will be killed by a Virgo.
AQUARIUS	♒	You will be killed by a Virgo.
PISCES	♓	You will be killed by a Virgo.

What are they carrying to the sky?

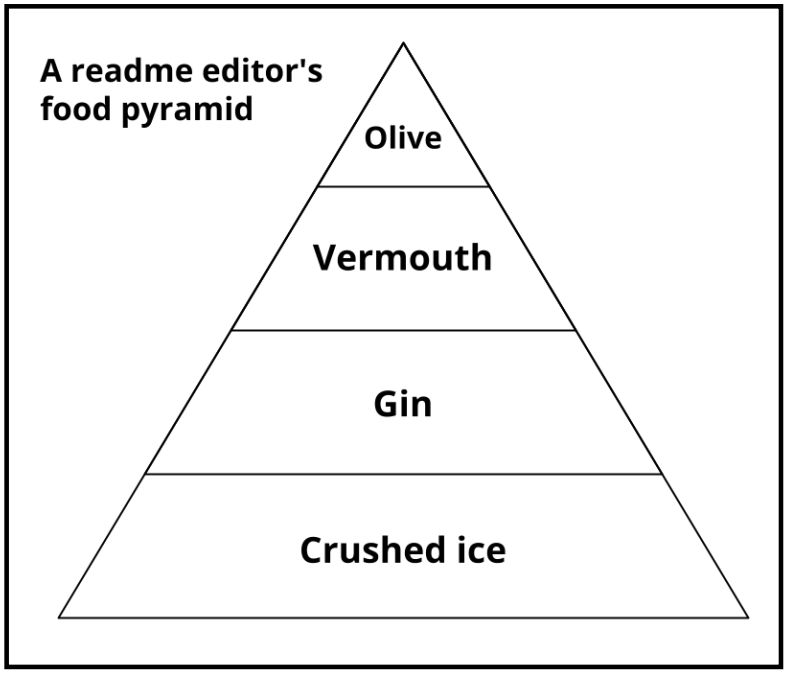
Allyn
Boeing's #1 Fan

Walking to the Sky, installed in 2006 by prominent war criminal Jonathan Borofsky, is an iconic fixture of CMU's campus. Many have noticed that on some cloudy mornings, the statue standing on its lowest rung will be one step higher, and a new soulless, gendered sculpture will have taken its place. Nobody knows what happens to the statue at the highest position. Presumably, it has walked to the sky.

Several months ago, such a shift occurred. But a student sitting on the Cut in a lawn chair with a superzoom camera lens noticed something odd: the newest sculpture was carrying something. It appeared cylindrical in shape, wrapped in cardboard. The arm of the sculpture had cracks from the weight of whatever was in the package.

The next sculpture to be added was carrying yet another suspicious object. This time, it was a sleek sheet metal box, with several cameras and infrared sensors on one side. The progression of ever more alarming devices on Walking to the Sky continued until the first sculpture, still burdened by its mysterious cargo, reached the top and passed on. We don't know where it is now. Assuming the transfer occurs at a force of 7,000 kilonewtons, we arrive at a likely target somewhere in Canada.

Some of the sculptures around the base of Walking to the Sky seem opposed to the use of the installation for military purposes. Daddy Thicc was spotted the other day carrying a sign advocating for peace and solidarity with the Canadian people. His child has been conscripted and can be seen carrying a rifle. Students sit by with bated breath. We can only hope that a peaceful resolution is reached.



Tales From Beyond Frick Park

What happens if you stay up late in Gates 8?

"Roan Tysh"
Drowsy

I am a fan of Gates 8. It's high up with a gorgeous view of campus, but not too high. It's quiet, but just noisy enough that you know it's safe. Sometimes I hear a skittering I can't quite place. I study, I play games, sometimes I just read books. Safe books, quiet books. I came to campus once in 2026, but I was sent off, and now I am back. It's not the same, but I can recognize it when I try.

Sometimes, the hours grow late. The sunset isn't visible from my little nook in Gates 8. But I see the sky darken. I am comforted by it. I hear fewer noises. No coffee maker and a little less conversation, but the skittering is more frequent, and I am comfortable. It's quiet, but not so silent as my dormitory, blackout curtains drawn all hours of the day, cold pack on the nightstand, refrigerator unplugged as soon as I come through the door. I don't like the noise. Sometimes I hear slamming muffled by the concrete over my head. It's not at all like Gates 8.

Sometimes I stay particularly late. It grows almost silent. I sometimes think I can hear the ticking of the clock in the office closest. I think I can discern something chewing on plaster in the loneliest hours of the night. My laptop shines white light into my face, but the lights are off. I'm too still. It is sometimes too quiet. I don't object, but my shadow looms just out of my sight.

It was an odd couple of years. I don't know why I was sent, even still. I don't know what they did to deserve it or why I did what I did in turn. I don't know why I thought it would sit right in my hands. It bruised my shoulder and pinched my fingers. It was too loud, too sudden. But I did what I thought was right with it.

I like it when I hear the coffee maker turn on in the morning. Usually the dark sky is a little lighter. The footsteps reassure me.

In the darkest hours of the night I hope to see something dark and quick scurry by. It darts from one shadow to another. It's amazing how many dark crevices you never notice. It comforts me. Its footfalls are quiet but not silent. The ticking of the clock goes in and out, sometimes it seems to find some long-hidden lubrication or lose a troublesome mote of dust in the gearwork.

A few nights the skittering isn't there at all. Sometimes it is those nights when it is utterly silent. My mind refuses to read. I wish to make noise to substitute but it is hollow noise. It is my noise. I still don't know why I was sent.

Senior Starts Quantitative Finance Firm Specializing in Block Market

Bertie Wooster
Invested a sizeable amount

At Carnegie Mellon University, the start of the 2025 school year has witnessed the rise of a new financial titan: a junior Computational Finance major, Manya N. Power, has launched QuantBlock Solutions, a quantitative finance firm specializing in trading the block market. "The emotional, speculative trading of the freshman selling and the sophomores buying is inefficient," Manya stated from the Hunt Bloomberg Terminal, which she has not left in days, much to the annoyance of several Tepper students who have taken to networking with each other while waiting in line for the terminal to clear up.

Manya's firm operates on a proprietary model that utilizes on a range of variables, from upcoming midterms to the current Schatz menu. Initial seed-funding was secured through a freshman who has pledged all of their meal blocks to QuantBlock, instead opting to subsist solely on pizza from club meetings, in exchange for access to premium insights during the coming Spring semester.

The emergence of such a sophisticated operation has sent shockwaves through campus; gut-feeling traders previously responding to posts within seconds have found themselves outpaced by bots. However, such success is not without scrutiny. The Student Senate is debating the long-term implications of derivative products, though consensus seems to be that block futures and collateralized dining obligations pose little long term risk.

During a recent career fair, Manya was witnessed talking to a Jane Street representative about "alpha generation in a market ripe for distribution." Whether this was about the meal block market as a whole or the complimentary bananas remains to be seen. Meanwhile, the traditional traders pore over every word, attempting to reverse engineer her decisions. Some claim a single misstep—a bad batch of sushi at Wild Blue, another case of dysentery from Hunan—could trigger a cascade bringing down this financial empire, and the block market with it. For now, Manya works on, downing Celsius after Celsius basked by the eerie glow of the terminal.